

INSTALLING WINDOWS 11 AND DRIVERS

2025



PREPARED BY
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CCNA
Period 0 - 2

1. Purpose:

The purpose of this lab was to install windows 11 pro version on a clean hard drive and install the apps needed for future work on the system.

2. Background:

Windows 11 is the current major release of the Windows NT operating system line, released on October 5, 2021. In October 2020, reports emerged that windows were working on a new visual overhaul for windows 10. The overall design aim was to reinvigorate the windows UI and make it more fluid.

By December 2020, Microsoft had begun to implement some of these changes, such as new system icons, improvements to task view, x86-64 emulation on ARM, and the Auto HDR feature from Xbox series X. Later, on June 24, 2021, Windows 11 was officially announced at an event hosted by Chief Product Officer, Panos Panay.

Windows 11 was a major visual overhaul compared to its successor, implementing the fluent design system. The fluent design system was designed to give a refresh to the UI of windows, and It has five core components, light, depth, motion, material, and scale.

The purpose of light is to draw attention and to illuminate information. For example, a reveal highlight is drawn around buttons in UI objects when they are hovered over, revealing the hidden borders of the button.

Depth is used to add context through layering in the z axis. In windows 11, this concept is expanded upon by using different opacities of the mica material

Motion is also used extensively throughout the design, with add/delete animations, connected animations (animations used during item transitions), drill transitions (used with navigating deeper into an app), fade (used to bring items into focus and back out of view), and press feedback, temporarily causing elements to fade into the background.

In fluent design there are two types of materials, occluding and transparent. Occluding surfaces are used in the base layer of UI, and transparent surfaces are used for interactive elements. There are two occluding materials, acrylic and mica, and one transparent material, smoke.

In addition, many of the UI elements have been changed to follow the new fluent design system. For example, the start menu has been moved to the center, as well as the search bar. They have also been changed to conform with the new design system, rounding the corners and adding new animations.

The taskbar has also been changed, as it is now center aligned by default, and includes new animations for moving, clicking, and pinning applications.

Some additional notable UI changes includes the File Explorer, the addition of new themes, sounds, and widgets.

Windows 11 also came with many security changes, such as requiring secure boot by default. However, these changes were quite controversial, as they raised the minimum specifications.

Overall, Windows 11's was received quite well for its UI upgrades and new security features, and it has become the most popular version of Windows, overtaking windows 10.

3. Lab Summary:

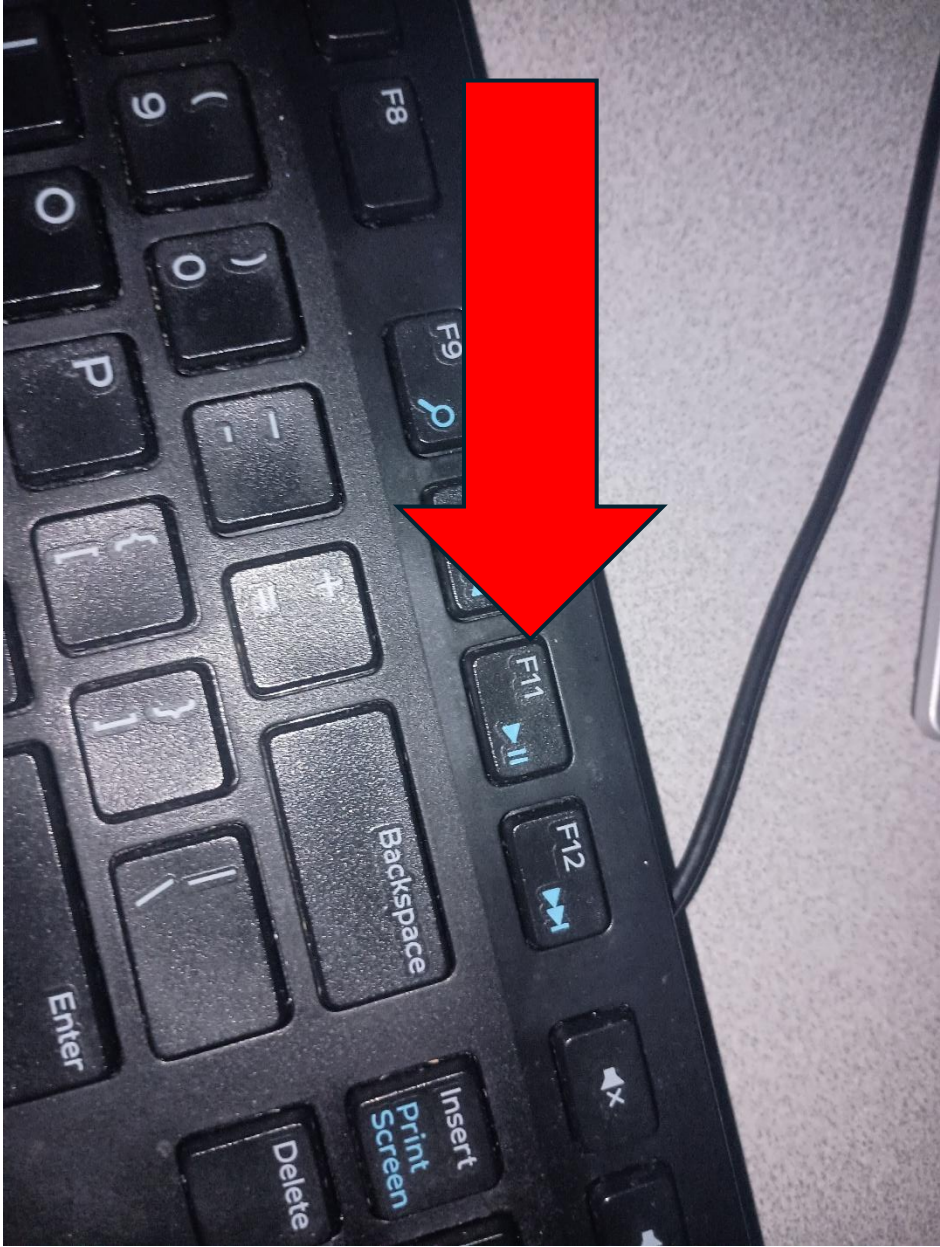
For this lab, I installed windows 11 pro on a fresh hard drive, and I installed the apps and drivers necessary to use it for other labs in the future. I installed the Nvidia drivers via the Nvidia app, and I installed the apps Libre Wolf, office 365, packet tracker, Wireshark, PuTTY, and Microsoft teams.

4. Configs:

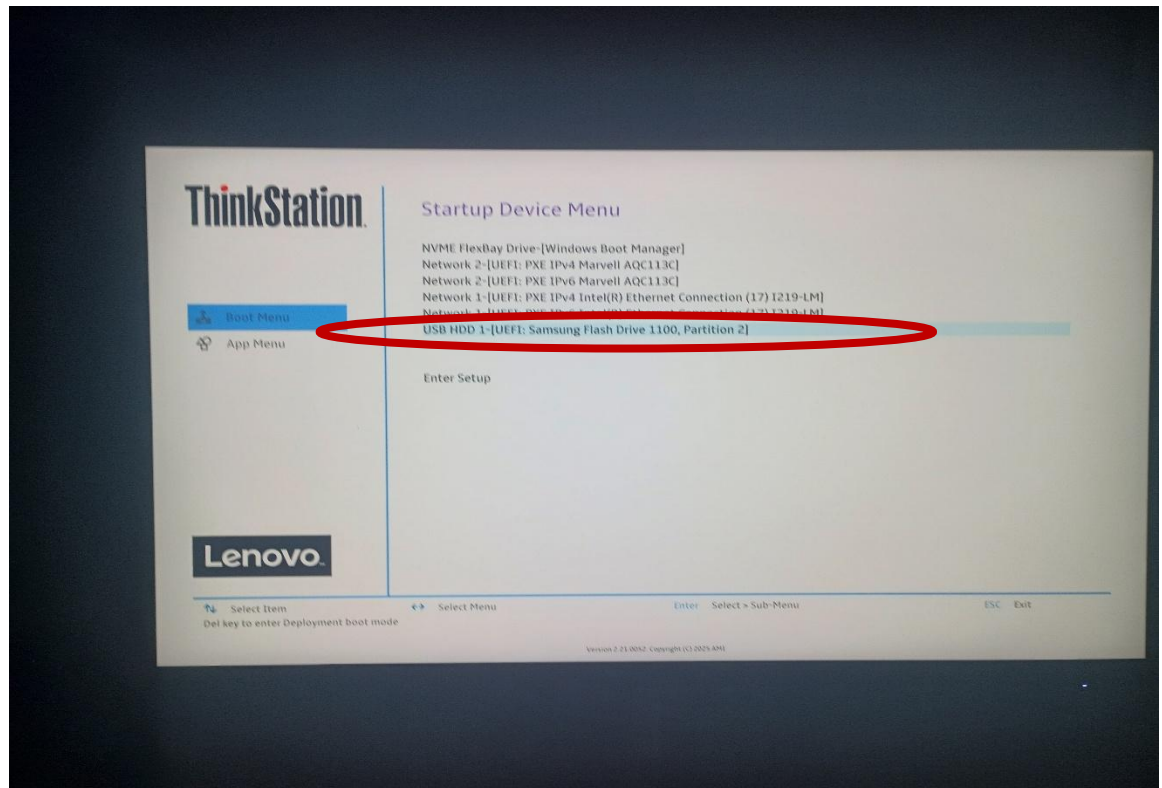
1. Plug in a flash drive with the Windows 11 install ISO



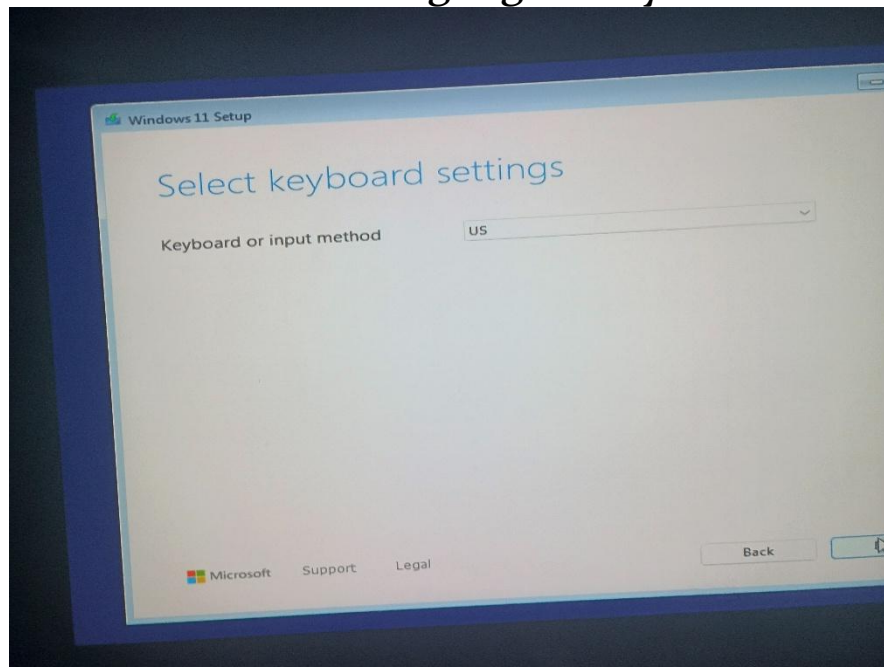
2. Press the f12 key to enter boot menu

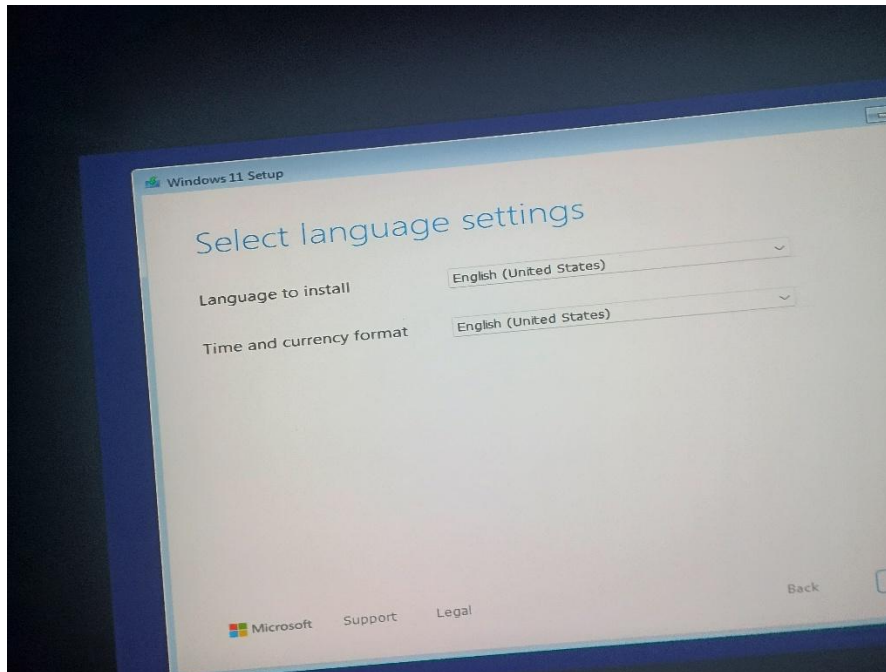


3. Select to boot from flash drive

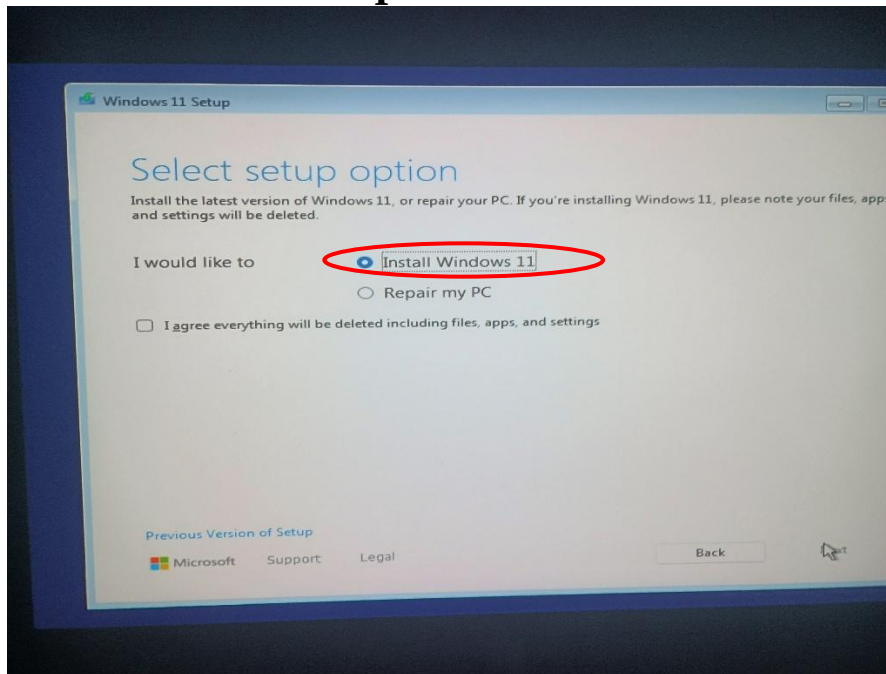


4. Select the correct languages for your installation

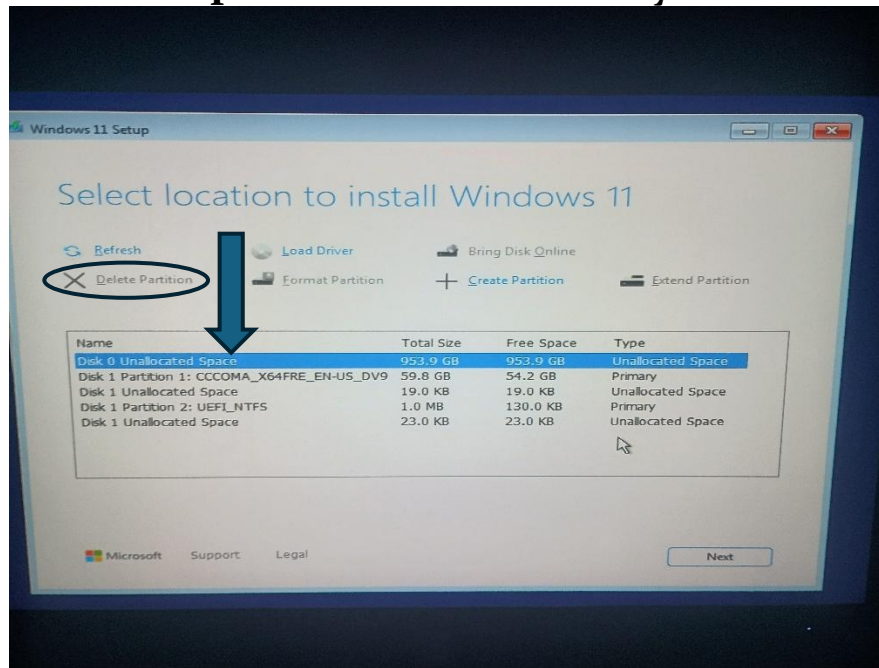




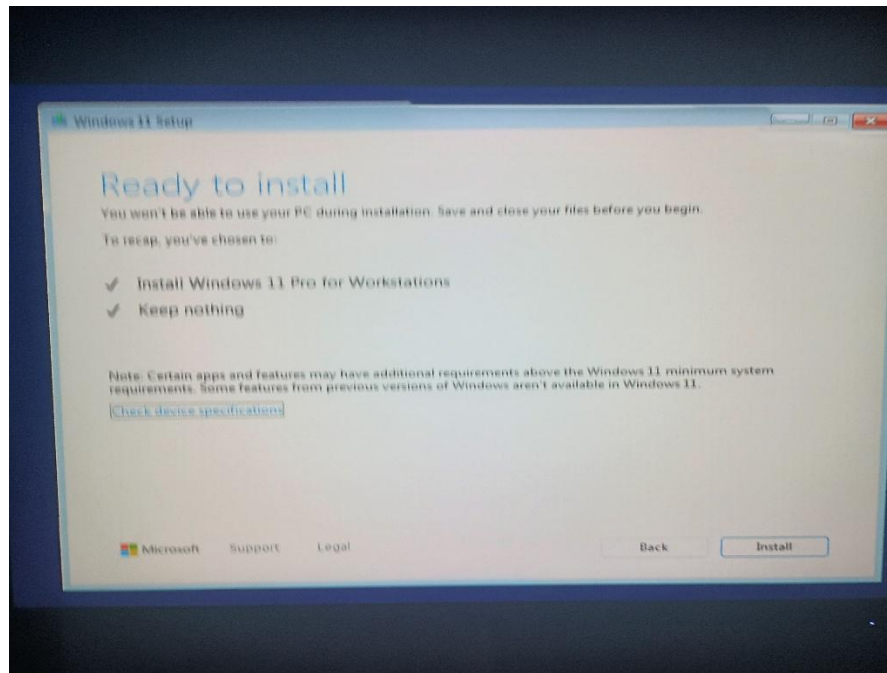
5. Select the install option



6. Delete all partitions on the disk you are installing to



7. Install



[illegible]

When installing windows, I ran into one major issue. Halfway through the installation, the process errored out, and it gave no explanation except for that my windows 11 installation had failed. However, this did not lead to much concern as I was able to simply retry installation.

Finally, the method I chose to install the office applications was unnecessary. I spent about 2 hours wrangling the Office Deployment Tool into installing the office applications I needed. However, that could have been avoided by simply going to [this](#) site and simply installing the apps that I needed.

Overall, this lab was a good refresher on how to install operating systems on fresh hard drives. It also was a good introduction to troubleshooting and solving unexpected problems that might arise. The skills I have practiced in this lab will be valuable in future ones